



BEFORE

The Civil War was the first major war in which railroads played a crucial role. At sea, the Union naval blockade posed a special problem for the South.

RAILROAD ADVANTAGE

The **North**, with many more miles of track (see [The Railroad in War](#)), held the advantage with their railroads. But the **South's interior lines of transportation made it easier** to transfer troops and material from place to place.

ANACONDA PLAN

General Winfield Scott's "[Anaconda Plan](#)" and the Union blockade (see [Blockading the South](#)) were intended to **cut off the South from overseas trade and supplies**. In response, **Southern blockade-runners delivered cargoes** containing everything from Enfield rifles and German sabers to cognac and medicine.

In the spring of 1863, if a Union army—such as Major General William S. Rosecrans's Army of the Cumberland—came marching down a dusty highway, its thousands of tramping infantrymen, its horse-drawn artillery and caissons (ammunition wagons), and its ambulance train all would constitute just part of the spectacle of an army in motion.